

Prototype Judging Rubrics

Ideation	25%
Visual Diagram and Mindmaps	8%
No mindmap or diagram present.	0-1
Single rough sketch or a list dressed up as a diagram. Hard to follow.	2-3
Clear mindmap showing the core idea and a few branches.	4-5
Well-structured mindmap with multiple branches and visible connections.	6-7
Rich, multi-layered mapping (mindmap + problem tree or user-flow) that clearly illustrates the ideation process.	8
Iteration and Idea Evolution	7%
One idea, unchanged start to finish.	0-1
Only minor tweaks with it being essentially the first idea.	2-3
At least one clear pivot or refinement, with reasoning shown.	4-5
Multiple documented iterations showing how and why the idea evolved, including dropped directions.	6-7
Mentor Consultation and Feedback Integration	7%
No mentor consulted.	0-1
Mentor mentioned, but no specific feedback shown.	2-3
Specific feedback documented and partially acted on.	4-5
Feedback from mentor(s) is clearly documented and has been meaningfully incorporated into the concept, where appropriate.	6-7
Breadth of Exploration	3%
Only one idea ever considered.	0
A couple of alternatives named but not weighed.	1-2
Several distinct ideas generated and compared before choosing, with rationale.	3

Creativity and Novelty	15%
Originality	7%
Copied or very common idea.	0-1
Similar to existing apps with small changes.	2-3
Fresh angle on a familiar problem.	4-5
Demonstrates a genuinely original approach or combines existing ideas in a novel way.	6-7
Novel Features or Twists	5%
No distinctive features.	0-1
One smart or unexpected feature.	2-3
Multiple clever features or a standout twist that defines the product.	4-5
Differentiation from Existing Solutions	3%
Indistinguishable from what already exists.	0
Some difference, but overlaps heavily.	1-2
Clearly explains why it's different and better than current options.	3

Feasibility	15%
Technical Viability and Tech Stack	6%
Unrealistic, wrong or no tools.	0-1
Might work, but major technical gaps.	2-3
Sound stack, mostly buildable with minor unknowns.	4-5
Appropriate technologies are selected, with a realistic implementation approach.	6
Planning and Scope Realism	5%
No plan, scope wildly unrealistic.	0-1
Rough plan, scope too big or unclear.	2-3
Clear, achievable scope with a concrete build plan.	4-5
Resource and Time Awareness	4%
No sense of time, cost, or team limits.	0-1
Some awareness but gaps remain.	2-3
Realistic grasp of what's needed to build it (time, skills, cost).	4

Presentation	15%
Clarity of Explanation	5%
Confusing; idea not understandable.	0-1
Understandable but patchy.	2-3
The idea is explained clearly and is easy to grasp.	4-5
Structure and Flow	4%
Disorganised, hard to follow.	0-1
Some structure but jumps around.	2-3
Logical, well-paced flow from problem to solution.	4
Delivery and Confidence	4%
Hesitant or flat, hard to engage with.	0-1
Reasonably confident, some energy.	2-3
Confident, engaging, and convincing.	4
Engagement and Persuasiveness	2%
Doesn't make the idea feel worth building.	0
Somewhat compelling.	1
Makes the idea feel genuinely valuable and exciting.	2

Design	10%
Visual Consistency	4%
No consistency; jarring or missing.	0-1
Some consistency in colour/type/layout.	2-3
Cohesive, polished visual style throughout.	4
Usability and UX	4%
Confusing or unusable.	0-1
Usable but with friction.	2-3
Intuitive, clear UX with attention to how people actually use it.	4
Mockup Completeness	2%
Missing or fragmentary.	0
Partial, covers only some key screens.	1
Covers the core flow end-to-end.	2

Impact	20%
Understanding the Problem Context	5%
Demonstrates little understanding of the challenge statement.	0-1
Understands the general problem but misses important aspects or constraints.	2-3
Clearly demonstrates a strong understanding of the challenge, its causes, stakeholders, and real-world implications.	4-5
Target Group Alignment	5%
No clear user group.	0-1
Broad "everyone" audience; weak fit.	2-3
Specific target users identified, and the solution clearly speaks to their real need.	4-5
Effectiveness of the Solution	7%
Doesn't really address the problem.	0-1
Helps a little, but the effect is small or partial.	2-3
Meaningfully solves the problem for the target group.	4-5
Solves it significantly and convincingly; clear before/after difference.	6-7
Reach and Scalability	3%
One-off, can't grow.	0
Some potential to reach more users.	1-2
Clear path to scale or wider impact beyond the initial group.	3